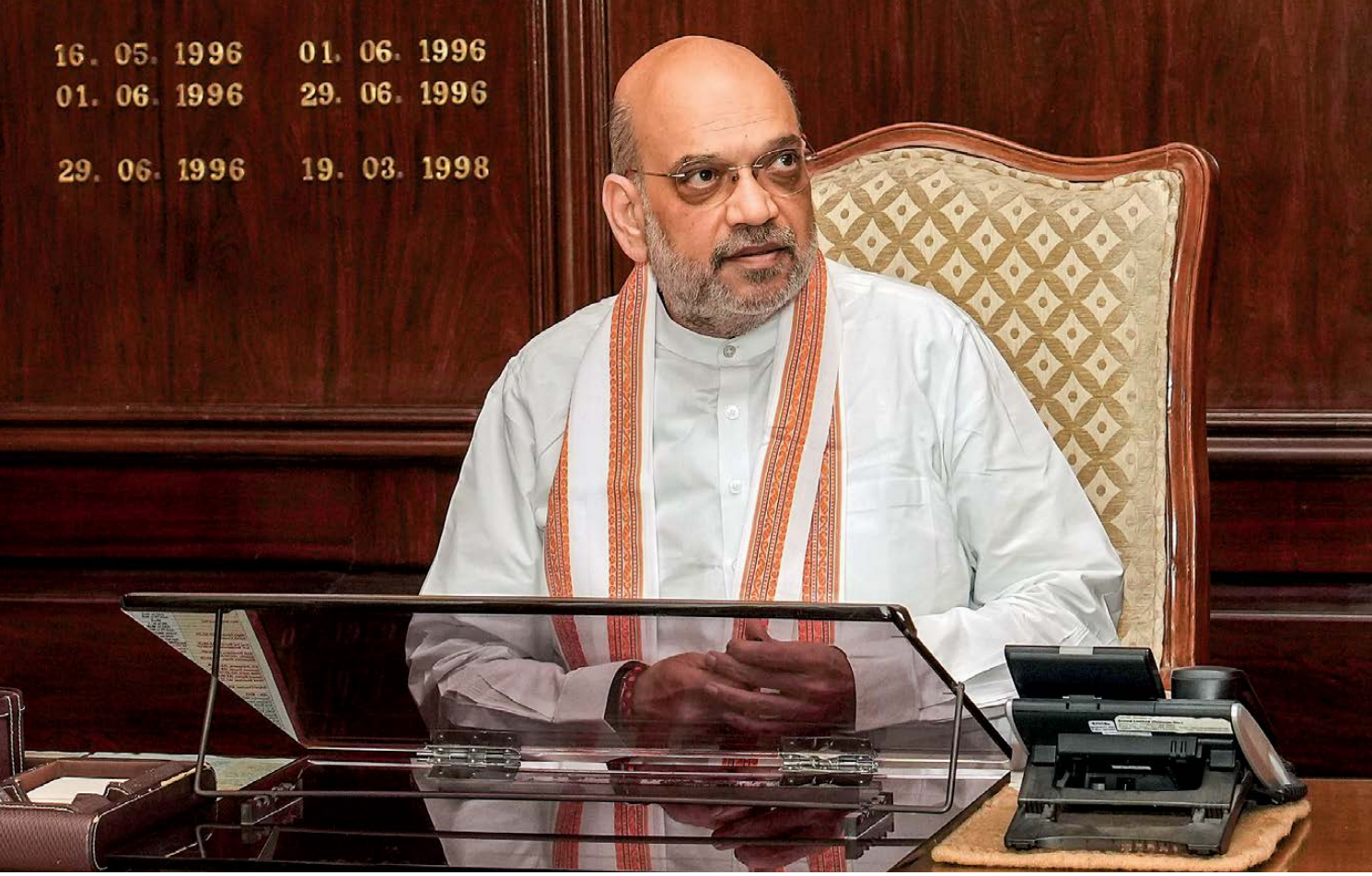


PTI

through physical barriers or deploying advanced surveillance tech

TACKLING LWE Efforts to eliminate left-wing extremism must continue, combining security ops with development initiatives

HOLD POLLS IN KASHMIR, BRING PEACE TO MANIPUR The revocation of Article 370 and downgrading of Jammu & Kashmir to a Union territory had left the region in a state of limbo. It is imperative that assembly polls are held soon, especially as a trickle of terror attacks has begun. Likewise, the Centre needs to resolve the Manipur issue before it becomes a festering wound

CYBER SECURITY The nation needs not just protection from rising cyber threats and warfare but also strong data protection laws to secure personal and national data

COOPERATION

Boosting Cooperation

A ministry that came into existence only in 2021, it aims to strengthen the grassroots units that are the primary agricultural credit societies (PACS) and harness them as multipurpose organisations that can cater to a whole gamut of agriculture requirements

By ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

AMIT SHAH
Minister of Cooperation

Ministers of State

KRISHAN PAL, *67* | BJP
Three-time Faridabad MP

MURLIDHAR MOHOL, *49* | BJP MP from Pune; also MoS in civil aviation ministry

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Accelerate PACS digitisation Launched in 2023-24, the project involves computerising 63,000 functional PACS and large area multipurpose societies, LAMPS

Get all states to adopt model bylaws for PACS These can help increase sources of income and create new employment opportunities

Encourage farmers to use PACS They can be crucial for inputs, sharing farm gate infrastructure, decentralising procurement